

GB MINERAL CORRIDOR REPORT

# The GB Mineral Corridor Report 2026

Licensed mining concessions, commodity supply, and the investment climate  
across Gilgit Baltistan, Pakistan.

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Published by Durr & Zircon Consortium, a unified entity across three registered operating companies (Durr Mines and Minerals, Zircon Mines, and Earth Lux Mines & Minerals) holding ten licensed concessions across seven districts of Gilgit Baltistan.

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This report compiles publicly available survey findings, government policy figures, and this consortium's own licensed concession data. It is not a geological or investment prospectus. Boundary coordinates, assay data, and full geological reports are shared directly with verified investors and buyers on request.

## The investment case

Gilgit Baltistan covers over 43,000 sq km of mining area, most of it still unexplored. Of that area, roughly 1,840 sq km have been granted exploration licences and 898 sq km sit under active mining leases, leaving a substantial gap between surveyed potential and licensed ground. Pakistan's National Mineral Harmonization Framework, introduced in 2025, targets an 18 percent rate of return for investors nationally as part of a broader push toward value addition rather than raw ore export.

Three separate international commitments landed in 2025 alone, and each is publicly documented:

**United States.** A \$500 million partnership between Pakistan and US Strategic Metals, signed September 2025, covering the full mineral value chain from exploration through refining. First shipment (antimony, copper concentrate, and rare earth elements) moved in October 2025.

**Saudi Arabia.** A pursued 15 percent stake in Pakistan's Reko Diq copper-gold project, backed by a reported \$540 million commitment, alongside Saudi Fund for Development interest in Pakistani mining infrastructure.

**China.** Pakistan has invited China to the Pakistan Minerals Investment Forum in Islamabad, April 2026, targeting an estimated \$6–8 billion in annual mineral export potential, with over 300 Pakistani companies visiting China and 167 MOUs signed at a single business conference in September 2025.

None of these commitments are specific to Gilgit Baltistan, but the commodity mix they target, copper, gold, antimony, and rare earths, is exactly what this region's licensed concessions carry.

## OPERATOR-LEVEL DATA

### Licensed concession registry

Ten licensed concessions across seven districts, held under three registered operating companies. Minerals listed are the deposit's own declared indications; boundary coordinates and full geological reports are not published here and are shared with verified counterparties on request.

| Concession         | District | Minerals                      | Area            | Status      |
|--------------------|----------|-------------------------------|-----------------|-------------|
| Bagicha            | Skardu   | Ruby, marble, quartz, lithium | 20 sq/km        | Operational |
| Gultari            | Gultari  | Molybdenum, antimony, lead    | 20 sq/km        | Operational |
| Kharmang           | Kharmang | Copper, iron, silver          | 9.9 sq/km       | Operational |
| Skardu Placer Gold | Skardu   | Placer gold, black sand       | 26 km riverbed  | Operational |
| Hilal Abad         | Kharmang | Copper, iron, silver, gold    | 9.97 sq/km      | Exploratory |
| Shigar             | Shigar   | Copper ore, gold indication   | 8.87 sq/km      | Exploratory |
| Gojal Antimony     | Hunza    | Antimony                      | App. #2024-3435 | Exploratory |
| Ishkoman Granite   | Ghizer   | Granite                       | App. #2024-3122 | Exploratory |
| Jutial Nala        | Gilgit   | Silver, copper veins, lead    | 9.97 sq/km      | Exploratory |
| Gupis              | Ghizer   | Granite, marble, copper       | 10 sq/km        | Exploratory |

*Operator key: Durr & Zircon Mines Consortium holds Bagicha, Gultari, Kharmang, and Skardu Placer Gold. Zircon Mines holds Hilal Abad, Shigar, Gojal Antimony, and Ishkoman Granite. Earth Lux Mines & Minerals holds Jutial Nala and Gupis, and is offered for outright acquisition.*

## Commodities and demand context

**Copper.** Sourced from Kharmang, Jutial Nala, Hilal Abad, Shigar, and Gupis. Demand driven by EV batteries, solar infrastructure, and grid electrification.

**Antimony.** Sourced from Gultari and Gojal, Hunza. On most Western critical-minerals watch lists; demand firmed on flame retardants, battery chemistries, and semiconductors.

**Placer gold.** A licensed 26 km riverbed concession in Skardu, scaled for mechanized recovery. Gold is also a secondary indication at Hilal Abad and Shigar.

**Lead.** Sourced from Gultari and Jutial Nala, alongside associated silver and mineralized copper veins.

**Nephrite jade.** Lifted from the Ghizer valleys, available as raw boulder or dressed stone; a top export category to Thailand's colored-gemstone industry.

**Quartz & silica.** Sourced from Bagicha, alongside that site's ruby, marble, and lithium-bearing indications.

**Granite.** Sourced from Gupis and Ishkoman, both in Ghizer district, within a documented marble and dimension-stone belt running over 100 km.

## PARTICIPATE

### How investors engage

Mineral titles in Gilgit Baltistan can only be granted to a locally incorporated entity. Foreign investors participate through one of four routes:

**Joint venture.** Structured across the consortium's three registered operating companies, combining licence, local incorporation, and field team with outside capital and technical resources.

**Farm-in / earn-in.** A stake earned through defined exploration spend rather than an upfront payment, suited to junior exploration companies.

**Equity participation.** Direct equity in the consortium rather than a single concession, for portfolio-level exposure.

**Outright acquisition.** Earth Lux Mines & Minerals, the consortium's third registered company, is offered for complete acquisition.

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### Durr & Zircon Consortium

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Sources: Gilgit-Baltistan Mines & Minerals Department published rules and figures; Pakistan National Mineral Harmonization Framework, 2025; public reporting on the Pakistan-US Strategic Metals partnership (Sept-Oct 2025), Saudi Arabia's Reko Diq stake pursuit, and the Pakistan Minerals Investment Forum 2026. Full citations available on request. This document does not constitute investment advice or a guarantee of return; the 18 percent figure cited is Pakistan's stated national policy target, not a return promised by this consortium.